

ALEX ZAHARIA

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TECH STACK

Programming: Python, Java, C, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite)

Web Development: React, Next.js, Node.js, Express.js, FastAPI, Tailwind CSS, Vite

Data & Machine Learning: Keras, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, BeautifulSoup, Selenium

Dev Tools: AWS, GCP, Snowflake, Supabase, OpenAI, Docker, GitHub Actions, Adobe Illustrator & Photoshop

EDUCATION

Seattle University

Master of Science in Computer Science (Data Science)

Seattle, WA

March 2025 – Present

California Polytechnic State University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

San Luis Obispo, CA

September 2020 – August 2024

PROJECTS

Microsoft Stock Forecasting

June 2025

- Developed a time-series forecasting pipeline using a 20-day sliding window to predict 10-day OHLCV sequences.
- Trained RNN, GRU, and LSTM models; GRU achieved 0.068 MAE on validation set across five features.
- Benchmarked against a linear regression baseline (MAE: 0.0245) and visualized predictions for each feature.

SVHN Image Classification CNN

May 2025

- Built a convolutional neural network to classify 600K+ Google Street View digit images from the SVHN dataset.
- Trained grayscale models using Conv2D, MaxPooling, Dropout, and BatchNormalization; achieved 97.5% accuracy.
- Enhanced model generalization with data augmentation; final model reached 96% test accuracy on 26K+ images.

RevereXR Storytelling Hackathon

February 2025

- Interviewed Ezell's Chicken CEO Lewis Rudd to storyboard and prototype a VR game in Unity in a team of 5.
- Built a web app to automate social media post generation with React, FastAPI, and OpenAI in an 8-hour sprint.
- Presented the VR game concept and React prototype to a panel of 10 judges and 100+ attendees.

TikTok and Youtube Sentiment Analysis Tool

February 2025

- Built a pipeline to analyze TikTok content by transcribing audio and applying NLP-based sentiment scoring.
- Identified major limitations in detecting sarcasm and emotional nuance using transcript-only approaches.
- Experimented with time-series modeling of vocal tone to improve sentiment accuracy beyond text analysis.

Gridiron GPT

April 2024 – August 2024

- Crafted a fantasy-football toolkit using React and Express, helping win 2/3 leagues in 2024, earning \$1,000.
- Automated a pipeline to extract, transfer, and load 300,000+ NFL records from 10+ sources into Supabase.
- Engineered a search tool using the OpenAI API, converting natural language into PostgreSQL for querying NFL data.
- Developed RNN-based time-series models to forecast player projections and predict weekly matchup outcomes.

Haggle

January 2024 – June 2024

- Collaborated in a 5-person Agile team to build and deploy a full-stack online marketplace.
- Managed the GitHub backlog, wrote user stories, created UML diagrams, and collaborated on Figma wireframes.
- Engineered a user-authentication system using GCP OAuth, Nodemailer, JWT, bcrypt, and AWS S3.
- Integrated chat rooms and inboxes with TalkJS to support real-time messaging.

WORK EXPERIENCE

AI Research Assistant

June 2025 – Present

Seattle University

Seattle, WA

- Collaborating with CS and Civil Engineering faculty on computer vision methods for vessel height estimation.
- Designed experiments comparing 3 camera angles to reduce error in varying light and calibration setups.
- Drafted a project plan—including charter, scope, timeline, risk analysis, budget, and RACI chart—to guide research.

Membership Representative

April 2025 – Present

Columbia Athletic Club - Pine Lake

Sammamish, WA

- Qualifying leads, touring and consulting prospects, and managing member accounts/agreements using Compete.
- Built a dashboard using React and FastAPI to visualize CRM sales data, saving staff 3+ hours per week.

CERTIFICATES

AWS Academy Cloud Foundations

Issued May 2025

Google Project Management

Issued March 2025

Snowflake Hands-On Essentials

Issued March 2025